CASE STUDY · LOUDOUN COUNTY, VA

Loudoun County, VA: The Data Center Capital of the World

Loudoun County has the largest concentration of data centers in the world. A 2000 zoning memo let them be built without public hearings. The County grew rich on the tax revenue, then moved to rein in data center development as residents pushed back.

A case study by the Grade My Data Center research team

KEY TAKEAWAYS

What this case teaches

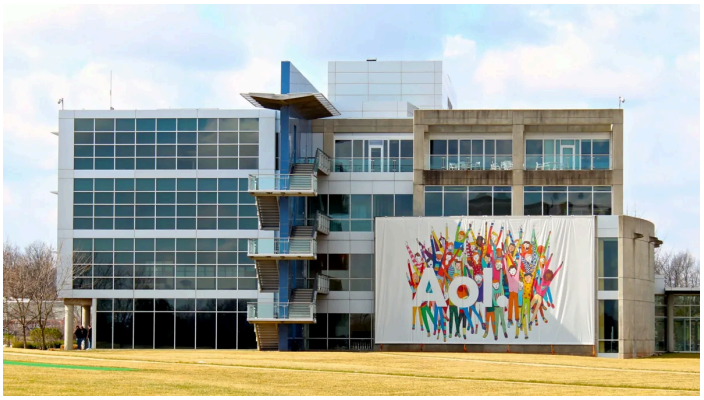
For local policymakers

- **How you classify data centers can last for decades.** A staff memo from 2000 treated them as offices, so they were approved without hearings for 25 years. No one voted on the initial designation.
- **Require public review for every project.** In 2025 the county switched to special exceptions with two public hearings. But grandfathered projects, 18.2 million square feet, can still go ahead without one.
- **Watch for budget dependence.** Data centers supplied 31% of local tax revenue in FY23. Most of it comes from equipment that wears out within five years, so the budget needs a steady stream of new projects.
- **Plan where they go.** A 2024 state report found that a third of data centers are within 200 feet of homes, partly because of weak local planning and zoning.

For communities

- **Organized, visible pushback changes outcomes.** Residents defeated a hyperscale proposal in 2024, pushed for new zoning in 2025, and helped win a 12-month pause in 2026.
- **Watch land sales and zoning applications.** The university campus sale became a data center plan before the public knew who the buyer was.
- **Ask for the missing numbers.** For the proposed Bridgefield campus, energy use, water use, cooling, and clean energy plans have not been shared.







“Not a single day without data center construction”

> ### “There has not been a single day without data center construction…in more than 15 years.”[1]

Just an hour from Washington, D.C., a county in Northern Virginia is home to 420,959 people–and more than 250 data centers, the largest concentration of data centers anywhere in the world.

Loudoun County started out as a typical suburb for the nation’s capital, a hub not for data but for professionals looking for a break from the city life. Now, it handles much of the world’s Internet traffic. Loudoun reports 53.3 million square feet, or 900 football fields, of data centers currently in operation or under development.

The county’s economic development office reports that there has not been a single day without data center construction in more than 15 years.[2] Depending on how communities, policymakers, and developers respond to current plans for 900 football fields worth of data center space in Loudoun County, there might not be a single day without data center construction for the foreseeable future.

How the industry arrived

Proximity to the nation’s capital and, along with it, access to high-voltage transmission infrastructure; demand for computing power from well-funded three-letter agencies like the Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI), Central

Intelligence Agency (CIA), and Department of War (DOW); and a foundational fiber network layout made Loudoun County a prime candidate for the data center industry.[3]

But, it remained underdeveloped until America Online (AOL) moved its headquarters from Tysons in Fairfax County, VA, to Loudoun in 1996 to secure cheap, open land for expansion. Steve Gaiten was one of the first AOL employees to drive to the company's new location. He wept upon seeing the exurban landscape and realizing that "his office would soon be in the middle of nowhere."[4]

AOL quickly got to work developing Loudoun County, initially creating 1,100 jobs and reaching 5,300 jobs at its peak in 2004.[5] The tech giant was described "[as] the internet," because so many people used its dial-up connections to get online.

The company laid thousands of miles of new fiber-optic trunk lines from Ashburn and its data centers to wherever the connection required it. Because AOL generated such a significant percentage of web traffic, other telecommunications companies and internet service providers (ISP) began laying fiber-optic lines as well, creating a feedback loop of data development.[6]

Then, peering arrangements began to develop. Two or more networks agreed to exchange traffic directly with each other, which allowed both providers to bypass sending traffic via third-party carriers. Those arrangements reduced latency, improved speed, and lowered bandwidth costs and transit fees.[7] Loudoun's latency, or rate for moving data from point A to point B, compounded: each new facility made the next one more valuable and the county more desirable for development.[8]

Once AOL moved to Loudoun County, a major internet exchange, called the Metropolitan Area Exchange, East [MAE-E] moved there as well. It was the world's first major commercial internet exchange point. Buddy Rizer, Executive Director of Economic Development in Loudoun said, "Every technology company wanted to be connected to that [exchange]. So they started laying miles and miles of fiber in the ground that benefited everything that came after. It was a domino effect–with all the other companies and technologies following."[9]

For the data center industry to thrive in an area it needs: fiber access and internet exchange points, access to electricity and sufficient grid infrastructure, and proximity to customers and available land and buildings for purchase. Loudoun County satisfied all of these criteria. It had MAE-E, a power corridor stretching from western Virginian and West Virginian power plants to D.C., vicinity to the nation's capital and its agencies, and open land just waiting to be developed.

But, Loudoun had one more incentive for development, which was perhaps the most significant catalyst for its "data center capital of the world" distinction: zoning.

Data centers as "office parks"

In 2000, Loudoun's zoning administrator issued a memorandum. Data centers, the administrator determined, would be evaluated as "office use," until such time as the Zoning Ordinance might be amended to define them as a separate use classification. Because office uses were permitted by right–meaning the owner has the right to build what they want without extra permits or hearings–in a range of districts, data centers became permitted by-right alongside them.[10]

Loudoun's classification in 2000 was made when servers were accessories to office buildings rather than industrial-scale freestanding structures. It permitted them by-right in office park districts until the county defined "data center" as a distinct use in 2014 and eliminated by-right approval in 2025.[11]

Elsewhere, local governments classified data centers as a form of industrial use, folding them into "industry and warehousing," "suburban manufacturing," or "wholesale trade and logistics" categories and subjecting them to standards written for buildings with entirely different operating profiles.[12] Either way, the effect of classifying data centers under another, unintended use has been the same: a land use with distinctive power, water, noise, and employment characteristics governed by rules that never anticipated it.

The office park classification in 2000 was an administrative interpretation, not a Board vote. There was no hearing, no public comment period, and no fiscal analysis. Board Chair Phyllis Randall would later describe it as a decision the administrator made "unilaterally." The name of the official who made it does not appear in the county's public record.[13] That memorandum shaped the physical form of the world's largest data center market for the next 26 years.

Becoming the data center capital of the nation

Before AOL and the 2000 zoning decision, Loudoun was a quiet, rural town. A former AOL employee described Loudoun with, "It was empty...There was nothing out there."[14] Now, the bustling suburban communities of Ashburn, Sterling, Dulles, and others are filled with neighborhoods, office buildings, shopping malls, restaurants and stores, luxury car dealerships, and Metrorail stops.[15]

However, while data center development was exploding in Loudoun County, most people had never heard of them, despite the county's newfound public largesse.[16] This was deliberate. Early developers made sure to keep their businesses out of sight and out of mind. Data centers "were tucked away and hidden" via nondescript buildings, little public engagement, and minimal governmental oversight. This culture of secrecy may have been related to the origins of the internet in (then) Department of Defense funding, the desire to buy land without sellers knowing what buyers could really afford to pay, and competitive market pressures as firms tried to outcompete each other. As a result, there was much less public opposition than there is today. Loudoun residents did not know enough about the issue to ask questions, let alone mount any organized effort against data centers.

Circumstances changed as the industry grew. It simply became too difficult for the tech giants to fly under the radar. Loudoun was the "Wild West" of data center development and the landscape changed rapidly. Soon enough, the first colocated data centers were developed. Colocation data centers mean "one company owns a data center and rents out its facilities, servers, bandwidth and/or public space to interested business."[17]

By contrast, hyperscale data centers are massive, single-tenant facilities that store, process, or transmit data on a massive scale. They are more than 10,000 square feet, contain more than 5,000 servers, and draw more than 100 megawatts of energy.[18] Typically, they are owned or operated by a "Big 5" tech company: Apple, Microsoft, Google, Amazon, and Meta.

As recently as Tax Year 2022, every one of Loudoun County's five largest taxable property owners was a data center landlord, such as CyrusOne, Digital Realty, and Equinix; neither Amazon nor Microsoft appeared among them.[19] By January 1, 2026, Amazon Data Services was the second-largest taxable property owner in the entire county at $3.72 billion assessed, and Microsoft Corporation was fourth at $2.01 billion.[20] The hyperscalers had stopped renting and started owning.[21]

Such a massive scale of development and operation resulted in an altogether unheard of tax base, leading Loudoun County to incredible wealth.

Among the wealthiest counties in the country

By 2007 Loudoun County became the richest county in the United States by median household income among counties with populations above 65,000, reaching $177,567 in 2023 against a national median of $81,604 and a Virginia median of $92,090.[22] It has held the top position since.[23]

The county almost doubles the nationwide median sale price of a home, at $810,185.[24] Furthermore, 64.6% of adults hold a bachelor's degree or higher, against 35.7% nationally; and 4.3% of residents lived below the poverty line, against 10.6% nationally.[25]

The fiscal mechanism

The revenue arrives through two channels. Data centers pay real property tax on land and buildings. Taxable real data center property in Loudoun reached $42.4 billion in 2024.[26] The larger and less visible channel is personal property tax on computer equipment, levied at $4.15 per $100 of assessed value.[27] Because servers depreciate and are replaced on short cycles, that base renews continuously rather than aging out.

By local government estimates, for every $1 invested into public services for data centers, Loudoun County receives $26 in tax revenue.[28] In Prince William County, the ratio is 1:13. For comparison, fiscal benefit-to-cost ratios for other types of development, such as manufacturing plants, rarely exceed 1:4.[29] Data centers offer a uniquely profitable deal to counties because of their disproportionate employee to square footage ratio, about 50 workers per 250,000 square feet.[30] Because a county budget is dominated by services delivered to residents–schools above all, then public safety and human services–the cost side scales with how many people a land use brings into the county.

Loudoun County's Board of Supervisors used the windfall to "increase budgets for schools, expand fire and emergency services, and improve roads, bridges, and tolls."[31] In July of 2025 the county opened a 117,000-square-foot recreation, exercise, and community gathering space.[32]

The Board also cut residential property taxes every year from 2016 to 2026, starting at $1.125 and dropping to $0.805 in 2025.[33] However, average assessed home values rose 78.3% over that same period, indicating a $1,390 increase in the average home tax bill.[34] Meanwhile, Prince William cut home property taxes from $0.906 to $0.865. Fairfax, far more economically diversified, dropped rates a quarter-cent, from $1.1225 to $1.12 (nearly 40% more than Loudoun's rate).

The dependency

Officials in the Loudoun County management and budget office reported that the county is significantly dependent on the data center industry to fund the county budget.[35] In FY23, data centers alone supplied 31% of Loudoun's local tax revenue and 7% of Prince William County's, the region's second-largest data center market.[36],[37],[38]

What makes the arrangement lucrative is also what makes it fragile: most of the revenue comes from equipment that depreciates within five years, so the fiscal model requires not a stock of data centers or employees, but a pipeline of development.

Juli Briskman, a member of the Board of Supervisors, recently questioned, "We've become addicted to the data centers for their tax revenues, but at what cost?" Some residents say that data centers have made Loudoun County a gold mine and one of the best places to live.[39] The concentration cuts both ways. A revenue base this large and this narrow funds schools, fire, and emergency services that would otherwise fall to residential taxpayers, and exposes them to any sustained decline in data center assessments.

The canary in the coal mine

> **"We are the canary in the coal mine."[40]**

In Loudoun County, data centers are neighbors. A 2024 impact report by the Joint Legislative Audit & Review Commission found that ⅓ of data centers are within 200 feet of residentially zoned properties, partly a result of "inadequate local planning and zoning."[41] Resident Suzanne Guida says, "I can hear the tonal hum both inside and outside my house."[42]

About 4.6 million gallons of potable water and reclaimed water are used by Loudoun County data centers every day, with the Potomac River and Goose Creek serving as the main sources of water.[43] Potable water consumption by data centers has increased 250 percent over the past four years, with signs only pointing to greater use in the future.[44] By the county's own analysis, the 250 facilities now consume roughly 10 percent of Loudoun's water supply.[45] As of April 2026, Loudoun County experienced "drought or abnormally dry conditions for 43 of the past 52 weeks."[46]

County electricity demand reached 1 gigawatt (GW) in 2018 and quintupled to 5.33 GW by 2025, "representing nearly a quarter of Dominion Energy's energy load in Virginia."[47] The Virginia Conservation Network reports that, "as of early 2023, data centers make up 21% of Dominion Energy's power load in Virginia, with PJM's projections indicating a doubling of the state's peak electricity demand through 2038."[48]

An analysis of the air quality, health, and economic impacts of the Vantage VA2 data center for instance communicated that the "facility's permitted emissions are estimated to result in between $53–99 million per year in health-related damages." Furthermore, "an estimated 3.4 to 6.5 additional premature deaths per year across the impacted region."[49]

Community opposition

Data centers' distinction as "office parks" meant that they could be approved administratively, with no public input or hearings. Campuses accumulated next to commercial strips, subdivisions, and schools not because anyone chose that pattern, but because nothing in the approval process required the question to be asked.

Because developers had no requirement to interact with community members and local regulators had no obligation to hold public hearings, community opposition to data centers lagged, despite the extensive environmental, social, and spatial impacts. Organized resistance did not scale with data center construction, but with procedural visibility and infrastructural externality.

It was not until 2022 that there was organized residential opposition to data centers, and even then, the protests were not about data centers themselves. Rather, they focused on high residential density, resulting from the massive development of the area.[50] Then, in 2022, one neighborhood surrounded by data centers had exhausted every option for reprieve and decided to sell to developers by applying to be collectively rezoned for industrial use.[51] By December of 2023, the Virginia Data Center Reform Coalition launched, an organization of 50 concerned local groups.[52]

In 2024, the issue of transmission lines created an organized movement in Loudoun. 31 organizations and 556 individuals signed a declaration of opposition to proposed 500 kilowatt transmission lines crossing through neighborhood and school districts.[53] Soon after, the Loudoun County Board of Supervisors "initiated a project to review and update policies and standards for data center and electrical substation uses."[54] This process led into significant zoning amendments in March of 2025.

A hyperscale data center proposed in March of 2024 sparked an outcry of organization and became the first data center defeated by Loudoun residents.[55] Over three dozen residents made public comments and the crowd waited past midnight to hear the board's decision. A later proposal of the same data center featured around a 78 percent reduction in square footage.[56]

Zoning Ordinance Amendment

On March 18, 2025, the Loudoun County Board of Supervisors voted 7-2 to amend their Zoning Ordinance. With the goal of ensuring greater oversight of location, design, and impacts along with economic advantages, Loudoun County shifted from by-right zoning for data centers to Special Exception (SPEX) approvals.[57]

Under the new zoning ordinance amendment, "data centers are no longer able to be approved administratively and are now required to seek and obtain approval of a special exception, which entails a stringent legislative review and public hearings before both the Loudoun County Planning Commission and the Board of Supervisors."[58] The SPEX process requires two public hearings, first before the Planning Commission, which takes public comment and makes a recommendation. Then, before the Board of Supervisors, which holds its own hearing and casts the final vote.[59]

The amendment slowed the approval process substantially. It also governs only what comes next. A grandfathering provision exempts applications submitted before February 12, 2025, for sites more than 500 feet from residential units, provided they are diligently pursued without substantial modification. Roughly two dozen projects qualified.[60] Any application submitted after that date would be subject to the amended ordinance. Planning and Zoning director Daniel Galindo put the grandfathered by-right pipeline at 18.2 million square feet, a 34% increase in the county's existing 53 million square feet.[61]

Current data center development: The Bridgefield Technology Center

February 27, 2026, George Washington University sold its Ashburn, VA, campus for $427 million, to an undisclosed buyer, likely as a result of yearslong financial woes.[62] On March 2, it was revealed that the buyer was Amazon. Amazon had plans for a hyperscale data center of 805,092 square feet. The proposed hyperscale campus will include four, two-story data center buildings and likely use about 120 megawatts (MW) of energy.[63],[64] Reporting confirms the campus is

adjacent to residential neighborhoods and that the nursing school building sits directly across the street from townhomes and condominiums.

George Washington University will retain use of the property at no cost, which includes 20 degree and certificate programs and 17 research labs, centers and institutes, for up to five years during its relocation process.

The proposed Bridgefield Technology Center is already facing fierce backlash. Buddy Rizer, Loudoun County's economic development director and so-called "godfather of data centers," publicly stated, "This is not an area where the county has ever–and I highlight ever–anticipated data centers."[65] District Supervisor, Juli Briskman, vowed to fight the proposal every step of the way and remarked that the development "would be a profound loss for the community."[66]

Residents, students, and faculty fared no better with the university in terms of answers. Chief financial officer, Bruno Fernandes said, "We couldn't do a lot of planning before making this announcement because of the confidentiality issues related to this transaction. So a lot of the planning will happen going forward." Furthermore, Julia Garbitt, university spokesperson commented that "officials will now consult VSTC campus leaders and community members as they navigate the sale's impact on campus programs."[67] As of Fall 2026, students and staff will be returning to the Virginia campus business as usual, with no plans released about the future of their programs.

A myriad of information gaps remain regarding the future data center campus. Energy draw, water usage, type of cooling system, clean energy use, among other details have not been shared.

The by-right question

Amazon's application does not seek a special exception. It argues the parcel is still governed by Loudoun's 1972 Zoning Ordinance, which controls many properties in the Route 28 Tax District, and that under the 2000 determination, data centers there remain an office use, permitted by-right.[68]

Executive Director of Economic Development, Buddy Rizer, spent 18 years monetizing a determination he inherited, and in July 2026 requested the opinion that dismantled it. On July 30, 2026, Zoning Administrator Teresa Miller declared that determination no longer in effect, finding that data centers had "acquired autonomy completely separate from Office use."[69] She did not address vested rights, or whether by-right approval survives in the Route 28 district.

If Amazon's reading holds, an 805,092-square-foot project proceeds administratively: no public hearing, no Planning Commission review, no Board vote, no fiscal analysis. Two zoning administrators, twenty-six years apart, will have settled the question, and the second one's reversal will not reach it.

"I think it's time that we just press pause"

In July 2026, the Board of Supervisors voted 6-1-2 to direct staff to prepare formal options for a temporary moratorium covering new data center applications, site plans, and substation permits.[70] Briskman, who introduced the motion, framed it plainly: "I think it's time that we just press pause." Staff were directed to present options at the Board's September 15, 2026, meeting.[71]

With standing room only, the Loudoun County Board of Supervisors met and discussed the potential pause. Ultimately, a motion passed (7-1-1) to have staff return in October with a resolution that would implement a 12-month pause on hearing data center applications. Essentially, the pause was approved, but the Board is still deciding exactly how to implement it.

During the meeting and via a legal memo, County Attorney, Leo Rogers, informed the Board that a moratorium would be illegal in Virginia. However, state code sets a 12-month deadline for the review of legislative applications (applications that require Board approval), which opens the door for implementing a pause over that period. Any applications sent to the Planning Commission after the Board adopts the pause resolution in October, "would not be addressed by the Board for a year."[72]

Notably, the pause does not include the processing timeline for administrative applications, submissions that are reviewed by staff rather than a public board. These by-right applications, estimated at 18.2 million square feet, would move forward through the review process normally.[73] Additionally, cases like the Bridgefield Technology Center do not fall under the temporary pause because of their "grandfathered" administrative status. But, the upcoming October meeting will also discuss whether the grandfathered exceptions can be ended for applications that have not been approved.[74]

During the yearlong pause, the county will finish writing its Phase 2 zoning standards, including data center compatibility and siting, utility substation, onsite power generation/battery storage, noise, and building heights policies. A former Loudoun County delegate said, "The standards being written now are the first real rules this county has had for these buildings. We ask that they be finished before [the Board] approve anything else under the rules that produce this."[75]

Data centers rule Loudoun County's entire economy and environment, and have for the past 26 years. It is a county that has more revenue, more staff expertise and experience, and more recent regulatory experience with data centers than any local government in the world.

The question is: can it regulate the industry that made it?

Notes

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Data Centers | Loudoun County Economic Development
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GRADE MY DATA CENTER ANALYSIS

Our scorecard review: Bridgefield Technology Center (proposed)

This part is separate from the case study above. Our research team filled out the Short Scorecard for this project ourselves, then looked at what the answers say about it.

How we graded it

We used publicly available information, on-the-ground interviews with local officials and community members, and Claude.ai to complete this scorecard – akin to the level of information a determined and LLM-savvy advocate would be able to access about the project.

See all 20 answers

Project Transparency & Community Engagement		2.5 of 8 points
1.	I know why this Data Center Project is being built here.	No
2.	I know who is developing the proposed Data Center Project.	Yes
3.	I know who to ask when I have questions about the Data Center Project.	No
4.	Project representatives have hosted opportunities to meet community members.	I don't know
5.	My local government has not signed an NDA (non-disclosure agreement) with the developer.	No
6.	It is easy to find information from multiple sources about the positive and negative impacts of the Project.	Yes
7.	The developer and local people seem to be working well together.	No
8.	The developer has signed a CBA (Community Benefits Agreement) or something similar.	No

Impacts to Energy Bills, Local Water, & Noise		0 of 8 points
9.	The developer has told the public how much energy the Data Center Project will use.	No
10.	I've been informed as to where energy for this Data Center Project will come from.	No
11.	I've been informed as to how the Data Center Project will impact my electricity & gas bills.	No

12.	I've been informed about possible air pollution from the Data Center Project.	No
13.	The developer has committed to NOT increasing air pollution in my area.	No
14.	The developer has told the public how much water the Data Center Project will use.	No
15.	I've been informed as to how this Data Center Project will affect local water quality.	No
16.	The developer has told the public about possible noise from the Data Center Project.	No

Quality of Life 0.5 of 4 points

17.	The developer has committed to hiring local people and creating local jobs.	No
18.	The Data Center Project is located in an area with other industrial or manufacturing buildings and not next to schools, hospitals, or local shops.	No
19.	I am aware of what will happen to this Data Center Project if the developer decides to sell the Project or close it.	No
20.	This Data Center Project will benefit my community.	I don't know

3 out of 20

2 Yes · 2 I don't know · 16 No · 0 Not answered

Yes = 1 point · I don't know = ½ point · No = 0

What worked

- The developer is known: Amazon bought the campus.
- It is easy to find reporting on the project's possible impacts from many local news sources and officials.

Concerns

- The project began with nondisclosure agreements, secrecy, and no community involvement.
- No information on energy use, energy sources, bill impacts, air pollution, water use, water quality, or noise.
- No CBA, and no commitment to local hiring.
- A university campus right next to homes, not an industrial site.
- It may go ahead with no public hearing, Planning Commission review, or Board vote.

Still unclear

- Amazon says it will seek community input, but none has started and there is no timeline.
- Whether the project will benefit the community depends on who you ask.
- Whether by-right approval still applies is being challenged, and the county's pause does not cover this project.

Our discussion of the results

Overall, the proposed Data Center Project for the Bridgefield Technology Center scores very poorly on the Data Center Scorecard, with 3 points of a total of 20. A score of 3 points indicates that little information has been shared with community members and community members may want to oppose this data center.

University officials began the development of this data center with nondisclosure agreements, secrecy, and zero community involvement. The developer and owner, Amazon, has not shared critical information regarding this data center's power output, clean energy usage, water usage, air pollution, community impacts, employment prospects, electricity and gas bill impacts, and more.

Instead, Amazon offered general information about their operations in Virginia. A spokesperson stated that "Amazon data centers are designed to use as little water 'as possible'," and that they use direct air cooling "96% of the year and only use water-based cooling during the hottest days."[76] Additionally, the company says that site development considerations will include community input, coordination with local leaders, and transparent public processes. None of this planning has started, and there is no timeline stating when it will: George Washington University has 5 years to fully vacate the property, and the by-right zoning for Bridgefield Technology Center to become a data center campus is still being challenged.

A Data Center Project that converts more than 120 acres; 800,000 square feet; and three buildings of a university campus calls into question what spaces and places are the "right" fit for a hyperscale data center campus. While brownfield sites and asset redevelopment projects are generally preferred for data centers, that guidance applies to industrial and manufacturing sites - not university campuses adjacent to residential areas. At a time when AI is rocking

traditional education and affecting recent university graduates' ability to find work, converting a university campus into yet another hyperscale data center feels metaphorical, like a harbinger of what is to come.

If the Data Center Project moves forward, community members will need to push for more transparency, more involvement in the planning process, more information about the energy and environmental impacts of the campus, more benefits to the community (and not just in terms of a larger tax base), and more awareness of what will happen if Amazon decides the Bridgefield Technology Campus no longer serves their needs, but has already converted the buildings into homes for servers. Local policymakers will need to back their advocacy.

In the best case scenario, the buildings will be upgraded with the latest building technologies, operate (rarely) off of the least polluting back-up generators, and be connected to an ever-greening grid. Like many hyperscalers today, Amazon will also commit to a water-positive plan for data center operations, storing up local reserves of fresh water. The design will still be compatible with future development options, including a re-conversion to a university campus. The landscape architecture will include plenty of green infrastructure to manage stormwater, provide cooling, and offer green spaces to surrounding residents. The benefits will include workforce development and training programs for local students, guaranteed jobs for local graduates, and regional hiring for construction and operation.

Questions 7 and 20 of the Scorecard are subjective, and initial interviews with community members indicate that they are highly dependent on a variety of factors, including opinions about AI overall and not just data centers.

76. Amazon proposes building over 800,000 square feet of data centers on GW's Virginia campus